Northstar Operations — Incident Management Runbook

Fictional sample for public demonstration; not real company data or policy.

1. Purpose & Incident Classifications

This runbook defines standard operating procedures for investigating, containing, and resolving service disruptions across Northstar platforms.

Severity Definitions:

- P1 (Critical Outage): Total service outage, critical data pipeline failure, or major customer impact.

- Acknowledgment SLA: Within 10 minutes.

- Update Frequency: Post status update every 30 minutes.

- P2 (Degraded Performance): Partial feature degradation, high latency, or non-blocking error rate spikes.

- Acknowledgment SLA: Within 30 minutes.

- Update Frequency: Status update every 60 minutes.

- P3 (Minor Issue): Non-urgent system glitch or low-impact internal tool anomaly.

- Acknowledgment SLA: Within 4 business hours.

2. On-Call Escalation Matrix

1. Primary On-Call Engineer: Initial responder; assesses alerts, verifies logs, and declares incident severity.

2. Secondary Standby: Coordinates cross-team debugging and incident communications.

3. Operations Coordinator: Manages status page communications and customer support alerts.

4. Engineering Lead: Escalation contact if mitigation exceeds 45 minutes without clear root cause.

3. Post-Incident Review (PIR)

- A blameless Post-Incident Review document must be published within 72 hours of incident resolution.

- Corrective action items must be logged in the operations backlog with an assigned owner and target completion date.